

FRIGHTEN

1. Passage anchor

> “She spoke in a calm, confident way, and she had this rare ability to make difficult ideas sound much less ****frightening****.”

Passage meaning

****frightening**** = causing fear, anxiety, or nervousness

****令人害怕的；令人畏懼的；令人緊張的****

Here, the difficult physics ideas were not literally dangerous. They felt mentally intimidating and scary to the student.

So:

> ****less frightening****

= ****沒那麼可怕；沒那麼令人畏懼****

Practice

1. The topic seemed ****frightening**** at first, but the teacher explained it clearly.
這個主題一開始看起來很****可怕****，但老師解釋得很清楚。
2. Good explanations can make difficult subjects feel less ****frightening****.
好的解釋可以讓困難科目感覺沒那麼****令人害怕****。

Core meanings of FRIGHTEN

2. frighten — cause someone to feel afraid

= make someone feel fear

****使害怕；嚇到；使受驚****

Examples

1. The sudden noise ****frightened me****.
突然的聲音****嚇到我了****。
2. The dog ****frightened the child****.
那隻狗****嚇到了那個孩子****。

This is the central verb meaning.

3. frighten someone

= make a particular person afraid

把某人嚇到

Examples

1. You **frightened me** when you shouted.

你突然大叫，把我**嚇到了**。

2. The dark room **frightened her**.

那個黑暗的房間讓她**感到害怕**。

Frighten someone into / out of doing something

4. frighten someone into doing something

= make someone do something because they are afraid

嚇得某人去做某事；以恐懼迫使某人做某事

Examples

1. The warning **frightened him into changing his behavior**.

那個警告把他**嚇得改變了行為**。

2. They tried to **frighten people into obeying**.

他們試圖用恐懼**逼人服從**。

5. frighten someone out of doing something

= make someone too afraid to do something

嚇得某人不敢做某事

Examples

1. The accident **frightened her out of driving** for several months.

那場事故讓她**嚇得幾個月不敢開車**。

2. Don't let one bad experience **frighten you out of trying again**.

不要讓一次不好的經驗**嚇得你不敢再試**。

Phrasal use

6. frighten away

= cause someone or something to leave because of fear

嚇走；嚇跑

Examples

1. The noise **frightened the birds away**.

那個聲音把鳥**嚇跑了**。

2. Loud music may **frighten customers away**.

太吵的音樂可能會把顧客**嚇走**。

Can be literal or figurative.

7. frighten off

= discourage or make someone leave because they feel afraid, worried, or uncomfortable

嚇退；嚇跑

Examples

1. The high price **frightened some buyers off**.

高價把一些買家**嚇退了**。

2. Don't make the course sound so hard that you **frighten students off**.

不要把課程講得太難，免得把學生**嚇跑**。

Very useful figurative use.

Adjective family

8. frightened

= feeling afraid

****害怕的；受驚的****

Examples

1. I was ****frightened**** by the noise.

我被那個聲音****嚇到了****。

2. She looked ****frightened****.

她看起來很****害怕****。

Important contrast:

* ****frightened**** = the person feels fear

* ****frightening**** = the thing causes fear

9. frightening

= causing fear

****令人害怕的；可怕的****

This is the exact passage form.

Examples

1. It was a ****frightening experience****.

那是一段****可怕的經歷****。

2. The problem looked more ****frightening**** than it really was.

那個問題看起來比實際上更****可怕****。

10. frightened of

= afraid of someone or something

****害怕.....****

Examples

1. She is ****frightened of spiders****.

她****害怕蜘蛛****。

2. Some students are ****frightened of speaking in public****.

有些學生****害怕公開說話****。

11. frightened to do something

= too afraid or nervous to do something

害怕做某事；不敢做某事

Examples

1. He was **frightened to ask a question**.
他**害怕問問題**。
2. She felt **frightened to speak in front of the class**.
她覺得**不敢在全班面前說話**。

Noun family

12. fright

= sudden strong feeling of fear

驚嚇；恐懼

Examples

1. The loud noise gave me a **fright**.
那個巨響把我**嚇了一跳**。
2. She cried out in **fright**.
她因**驚嚇**而叫了出來。

13. give someone a fright

= suddenly make someone afraid

把某人嚇一跳

Examples

1. You gave me a **fright**!
你把我**嚇了一跳**！
2. The sudden movement gave her a **fright**.

那個突然的動作把她**嚇了一跳**。

Emotional / psychological intimidation

14. frightening — intimidating or mentally overwhelming

= making something seem scary because it feels difficult, unfamiliar, or beyond your ability
令人畏懼的；讓人卻步的

This is very close to the passage.

Examples

1. University can seem **frightening** at first.
大學生活一開始可能會讓人覺得**很可怕 / 很有壓力**。
2. A complicated formula may look **frightening** to beginners.
複雜的公式對初學者來說可能看起來很**嚇人**。

This is not literal physical fear.

High-value expressions

15. frighten the life out of someone

= frighten someone very badly
把某人嚇個半死

Examples

1. That scream **frightened the life out of me**.
那聲尖叫把我**嚇個半死**。
2. The sudden knock **frightened the life out of her**.
突然的敲門聲把她**嚇壞了**。

Informal and emphatic.

16. frighten someone to death

= frighten someone extremely badly; usually not literal

把某人嚇死；嚇個半死

Examples

1. You **frightened me to death**!

你快把我**嚇死了**！

2. The thunder **frightened the child to death**.

雷聲把孩子**嚇壞了**。

Usually figurative.

17. scare / frighten someone away from something

= make someone avoid something because it seems too risky or unpleasant

讓某人因害怕而避開某事

Examples

1. Bad publicity **frightened investors away**.

負面宣傳把投資者**嚇跑了**。

2. Don't let technical language **frighten you away from science**.

不要讓技術性語言**嚇得你不敢接觸科學**。

Related forms

18. frighteningly

= in a way that causes fear or seems alarmingly extreme

令人害怕地；驚人地

Examples

1. The road was **frighteningly narrow**.

那條路**窄得嚇人**。

2. The machine moved **frighteningly fast**.

那台機器快得**令人害怕**。

19. frightful

= very unpleasant, bad, or frightening

****可怕的；糟糕的；駭人的****

Examples

1. The weather was ****frightful****.

天氣****糟透了****。

2. They heard a ****frightful scream****.

他們聽到一聲****可怕的尖叫****。

Often stronger and somewhat more literary or old-fashioned.

Key contrasts

20. frighten vs scare

****frighten****

= cause fear

****使害怕；嚇到****

****scare****

= very similar, often more common in everyday speech

****嚇到；使害怕****

Compare:

> The noise ****frightened me****.

> 那個聲音嚇到我。

> The noise ****scared me****.

> 那個聲音把我嚇到了。

Both are natural.

****Scare**** is often more conversational.

21. frighten vs terrify

****frighten****

= cause fear

****terrify****

= cause extreme fear

****使極度害怕；嚇壞****

Compare:

> The noise ****frightened me****.

> 聲音嚇到我。

> The explosion ****terrified everyone****.

> 爆炸把所有人都嚇壞了。

****Terrify**** is much stronger.

22. frighten vs startle

****startle****

= cause a sudden brief reaction of surprise or alarm

****使嚇一跳；使吃驚****

****frighten****

= actually cause fear

Compare:

> The door slamming ****startled me****.

> 門突然關上把我嚇了一跳。

> The threatening message ****frightened me****.

> 那則威脅訊息讓我感到害怕。

Something can startle you without truly frightening you.

23. frighten vs intimidate

****intimidate****

= make someone feel nervous, inferior, or afraid, often because another person/situation seems powerful or difficult

****使畏縮；使膽怯****

****frighten****

= broader; simply cause fear

Compare:

> The loud noise ****frightened**** me.

> 巨響把我嚇到了。

> The expert terminology ****intimidated**** the beginners.

> 專業術語讓初學者感到畏縮。

In the passage, ****frightening**** is close to ****intimidating**** because the ideas feel mentally difficult.

24. frightened vs frightening

This is essential.

****frightened****

= how someone feels

****感到害怕的****

****frightening****

= what causes the feeling

****令人害怕的****

Compare:

> I was ****frightened****.

> 我感到害怕。

> The experience was ****frightening****.

> 那段經歷很可怕。

Not:

> *I was frightening.*

> unless you mean:

> ****我讓別人感到害怕。 ****

25. frightened vs afraid

****afraid****

= feeling fear

****害怕的****

****frightened****

= also feeling fear, often with a stronger sense of being scared by something

Compare:

> She is ****afraid of dogs****.

> 她怕狗。

> She was ****frightened by the barking dog****.

> 她被那隻狂吠的狗嚇到了。

Meaning map

The central concept of ****frighten**** is:

****cause fear****

From this develop:

Direct fear

frighten someone

→ ****嚇到某人****

Forced action

frighten someone into doing something

→ ****嚇得某人去做****

Avoidance

frighten someone out of doing something

→ ****嚇得某人不敢做****

Departure

frighten away/off

→ ****嚇走 / 嚇退****

Feeling adjective

frightened

→ **感到害怕**

Cause adjective

frightening

→ **令人害怕**

Noun

fright

→ **驚嚇；恐懼**

The passage uses a figurative psychological extension:

difficult ideas seem scary or intimidating

→ **frightening ideas**

→ **令人畏懼 / 令人卻步的概念**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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frighten someone	使某人感到害怕；把某人嚇到
frighten someone into doing	以恐懼促使 / 迫使某人去做某事
frighten someone out of doing	使某人因害怕而不敢做某事
frighten away	因驚嚇而使某人 / 某物離開；嚇走
frighten off	使某人因恐懼、擔憂或不適而退卻 / 離開
frightened	自己感到恐懼、受驚；害怕的
frightening	使別人產生恐懼或畏懼；令人害怕的
frightened of	害怕某人、某物或某件事
frightened to do	因害怕而不敢做某事
fright	突然或強烈的恐懼 / 驚嚇
give someone a fright	突然把某人嚇一跳
frightening — intimidating	因太困難、陌生或有壓力而令人畏懼、卻步
frighten the life out of someone	把某人嚇個半死；非常強烈地驚嚇某人
frighten someone to death	把某人嚇壞 / 嚇死，通常是誇張說法
frighteningly	以令人害怕或驚人程度呈現；嚇人地
frightful	非常可怕、糟糕或令人震驚的

Passage recap

> “...she had this rare ability to make difficult ideas sound much less ****frightening****.”

Here:

****frightening**** = ****causing fear, nervousness, or intimidation****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****令人害怕的****

* ****令人畏懼的****

* ****讓人卻步的****

* contextually: ****沒那麼可怕****

Natural contextual translation:

****她能把原本很難懂、讓人畏懼的概念講得沒那麼可怕。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****frightening****

= ****causing someone to feel afraid, nervous, or intimidated****

****令人害怕的；令人畏懼的****

The key contrast is:

> ****I was frightened.****

> → 我感到害怕。

> ****The idea was frightening.****

> → 這個概念令人害怕。

So in the passage, the ****idea causes the feeling****, which is why ****frightening****, not ****frightened****, is used.